

Informal Congregation Preparation Meeting

Evidence-backed working aid. Current official direction and original documents remain authoritative.

Date: _____

Time: _____

Location: _____

Chairman: _____

Suggested duration: 90 minutes
Purpose: Prepare the Ashburton Tagalog Congregation to begin functioning on 1 November 2026 by identifying proposed role assignments, assigning preparation work and surfacing decisions that require formal approval or Branch direction.

Meeting boundary: This is a preparation meeting, not a body-of-elders meeting. Record proposed names and action owners. Formal appointments, congregation decisions, shared-hall decisions and external legal or banking actions must be made or confirmed by the authorised brothers or body under current direction.

What this meeting should produce

- Proposed names or follow-up owners for every priority responsibility.
- Owners and deadlines for the first month of meetings, ministry, records and Kingdom Hall arrangements.
- A clear list of matters requiring formal approval or outside direction.
- One action owner for the Branch Accounting/Legal inquiry; no unauthorised charity, tax or banking action.

Timed agenda

Time	Agenda item	Discussion	Required result
0-5	Opening and purpose	Prayer; restate the 1 November start date and the purpose of tonight's discussion.	Everyone understands what may be prepared, proposed or formally decided.
5-12	Where the project stands	Approval received; congregation 3814 in Circuit NZ-2; Adamson dela Cruz confirmed as coordinator and Dave Asuncion as secretary; review the Branch transition instructions without circulating confidential material.	One shared understanding of the approved identity, effective date and current arrangement.
12-37	Priority responsibilities and proposed brothers	Work through the priority role table: service overseer, meeting oversight, accounts, literature, territory, field service groups, cleaning and shared-hall liaison.	A proposed name or a named follow-up owner for every priority vacancy.
37-52	Meetings and teaching	First-month schedule; public talks; Life and Ministry assignments; Watchtower conductor and substitute; chairmen, readers, A/V and attendants; confirm Thursday 7:15 p.m. and Saturday 7:00 p.m.	Owners and target dates for the first four weeks of meeting schedules and rosters.
52-65	Ministry and publisher care	Field service group structure; publisher placements; interim S-6 territory; literature and periodical requests; pioneer and publisher-record transition after 1 November.	Proposed group structure and named owners for territory, literature and record reconciliation.

Time	Agenda item	Discussion	Required result
65–75	Administration, JW Hub and Kingdom Hall	JW Hub access; secure congregation file; S-21/S-88 records; information board; cleaning schedule; emergency contacts; S-46 shared-hall matters and Kingdom Hall Operating Committee liaison.	Administrative setup tasks assigned, with any combined-body decisions clearly flagged.
75–83	Optional: charity, tax, bank and accounting preparation	Confirm that Branch Accounting/Legal direction is needed first; identify who will obtain current S-27 and clarify the legal entity/account name; list—but do not yet execute—bank onboarding and conditional charity/IRD steps.	One inquiry owner and a document-gathering owner; no unauthorised registration or account opening.
83–90	Actions, deadlines and next review	Read back every action with owner and due date; identify what goes to the host body, prospective/new body, combined bodies, circuit overseer or Branch; set the next preparation review.	A complete action register and date for the next review.

Responsibility worksheet

Eligibility key: ✓ MS = qualified ministerial servant may be assigned · △ MS = conditional/only when the stated need applies · Elder = elder assignment.

Priority — fill or propose first

Responsibility	Current position	Eligibility	Proposed name / action	Formal confirmation	Reference
Service Overseer	To be confirmed	Elder	_____	Authorised body / current direction	SFG 1:10, 15-17
Life and Ministry Meeting Overseer	To be confirmed	Elder	_____	Body of elders	SFG 4:14
Watchtower Study Conductor	To be confirmed	Elder	_____	Body of elders	SFG 4:12-13
Accounts Servant	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:4, 14
Literature Servant	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:4, 17
Territory Servant	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:4, 17
Field Service Group Overseer(s)/Servant(s)	To be confirmed	△ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:18-19
Kingdom Hall Cleaning Coordinator	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 13:8
Kingdom Hall Operating Committee Representative	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Combined bodies of elders	SFG 13:6

Meeting support — prepare rosters

Responsibility	Current position	Eligibility	Proposed name / action	Formal confirmation	Reference
Substitute Watchtower Study Conductor	To be confirmed	Elder	_____	Body of elders	SFG 4:13
Public Talk Coordinator	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:12; 4:9(5)
Auxiliary Counselor	To be confirmed	△ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 4:15

Responsibility	Current position	Eligibility	Proposed name / action	Formal confirmation	Reference
Audio/Video Support Coordinator	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:4, 12
Attendant Coordinator	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:12
Public Talk Chairmen	Roster to be prepared	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:12
Watchtower Readers	Roster to be prepared	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:12

Optional or as needed

Responsibility	Current position	Eligibility	Proposed name / action	Formal confirmation	Reference
Field Service Group Assistant(s)	To be confirmed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:18-19
Secretary Support / Field Report Assistant	If needed	✓ MS	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:14
Assistant Service Overseer	If needed	Elder	_____	Body of elders	SFG 1:15

Questions to work through

- ☐ Which roles absolutely need a named brother before the first meeting, and which can be covered temporarily?
- ☐ Do the proposed brothers have the availability, ability and eligibility indicated in the organisation chart?
- ☐ Who has formal authority to confirm each proposal, and by what date should that confirmation be obtained?
- ☐ How many field service groups should begin on 1 November, and who will care for each group?
- ☐ Who will prepare and check the first four weeks of meeting, ministry and Kingdom Hall rosters?
- ☐ What records, access, supplies or information must come from Ashburton or other former congregations?
- ☐ What must be agreed with the other bodies using the Kingdom Hall?
- ☐ Who will contact Branch Accounting/Legal for the legal-entity and bank-account instructions?

Optional discussion — charity, tax, bank and accounts

Discuss only enough to assign preparation work. Do not create an entity, register with Charities Services, apply for an IRD number or open an account under an assumed name before Branch Accounting/Legal identifies the approved arrangement. Obtain the current S-27 before designing the accounting workflow.

Suggested discussion only:

- Who will ask Branch Accounting/Legal which legal entity, official account name, charity/IRD identifiers and bank process apply to congregation 3814?
- Who will obtain the current S-27 and accounting tutorials?
- Who can prepare—but not yet submit—the likely bank documents, identity evidence and draft minutes?
- If the Branch directs a separate registration, who will coordinate the approved governing documents, officers and statutory calendar?

Action register

Action	Owner	Approver / consulted party	Due date	Status / notes

Park for the next meeting

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Next preparation review: _____

Closing prayer: _____

Useful working links: [organisation chart](#) · [congregation start checklist](#) · [regular-pioneer review](#) · [persistent checklist](#)

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